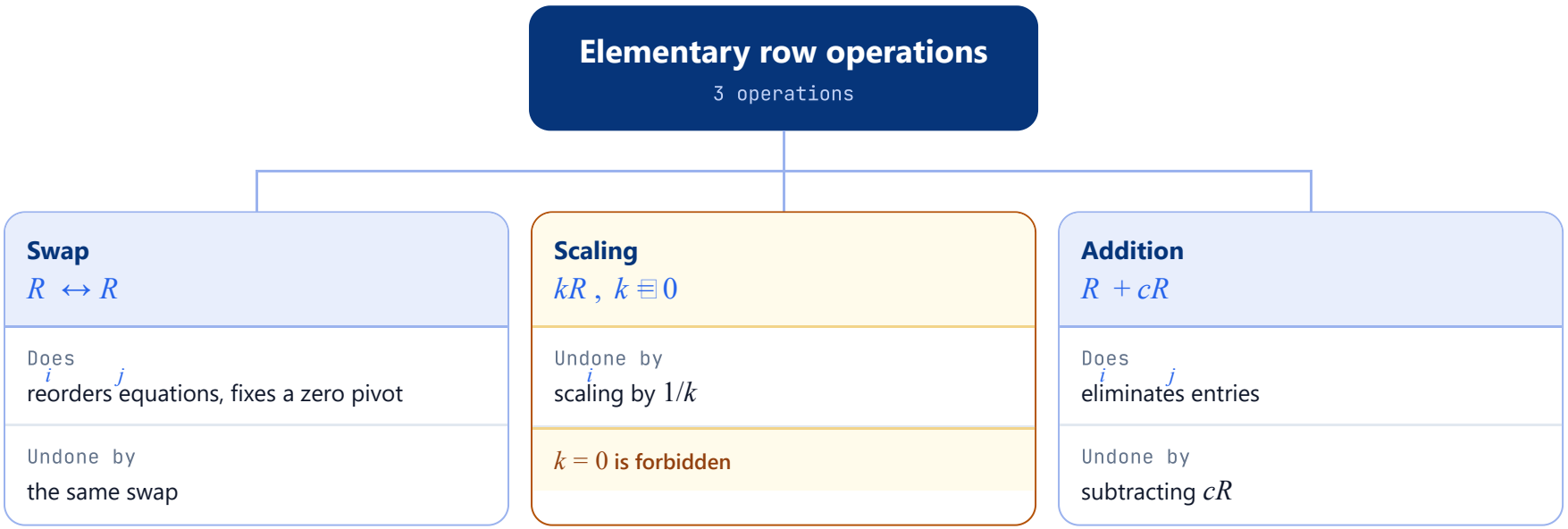
BEFORE YOU READ

Three moves, all reversible

Gaussian elimination uses only three operations on rows. Each one changes the system without changing its solutions, and each can be undone.



TAKEAWAY

Only one move eliminates

Swapping and scaling tidy the rows; adding a multiple of one row to another is the operation that actually creates the zeros.